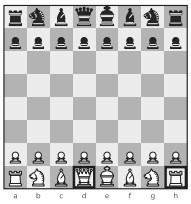
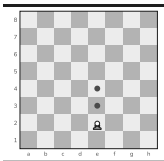
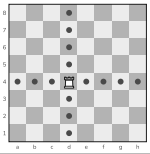
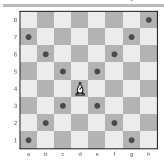
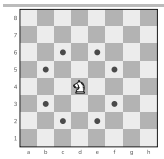
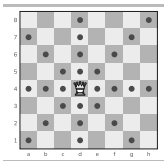
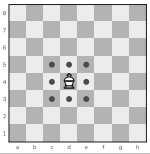
Every rule of chess on one page

The goal: trap the other king so it can't escape. That's checkmate, and it wins the game.



Setting up

A light square in each player's bottom right corner. The back row: rook, knight, bishop, queen, king, bishop, knight, rook, with the queen on her own colour (d1 for White). Pawns in front. White moves first.

	PIECE	HOW IT MOVES	REMEMBER
	**Pawn**	Straight forward one square; two on its first move.	Captures one square diagonally forward. Never moves backwards. Can't move forward if a piece is in front.
	**Rook**	Straight lines, any distance.	Can't jump.
	**Bishop**	Diagonals, any distance.	Stays on one colour all game.
	**Knight**	An L: two squares one way, one to the side.	The only piece that jumps. Always lands on the other colour.
	**Queen**	Straight or diagonal, any distance.	A rook and a bishop together.
	**King**	One square in any direction.	Never onto a square an enemy piece attacks.

CHECK AND CHECKMATE

Check: your king is attacked. Get out at once: move the king, block, or capture the attacker. You may never make a move that leaves your own king in check.

Checkmate: check with no way out. The game is over.

THE SPECIAL MOVES

Castling: The king steps two squares towards a rook; the rook jumps to the square beside it. Only if the king and that rook haven't moved, nothing is between them, and the king isn't in check, doesn't cross an attacked square and doesn't land on one.

Promotion: A pawn that reaches the far end must become a queen, rook, bishop or knight of its own colour. You choose; it's usually a queen.

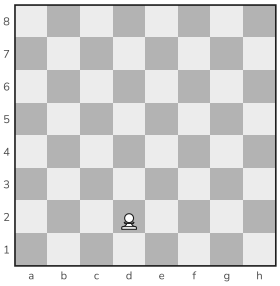
En passant: If an enemy pawn jumps two squares and lands beside your pawn, you may take it as if it had moved one. Only on the very next move.

Stalemate: It's your turn, you're not in check, and you have no legal move. It's a draw. Players can also agree a draw, and there are a few more ways to draw.

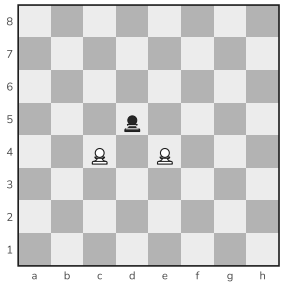
Rules checked against Wikipedia's 'Rules of chess' (read 7 November 2026). The ten boards are from RankUp Chess's own lessons.
From the RankUp Chess video 'How to Play Chess: Every Rule in 10 Minutes'. RankUp Chess is an offline chess app for children, where each rule is a short lesson you play. stillwareltd.com/rankupchess

Your turn: the ten boards from the video

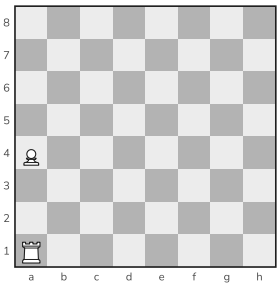
Try each one on a board, or in your head. The answers are upside down at the foot of the page.



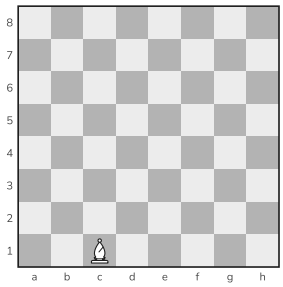
1 **This pawn hasn't moved yet. Where can it go?**



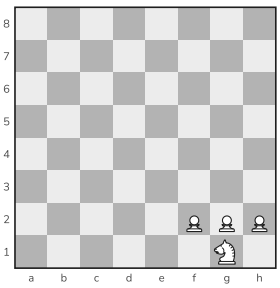
2 **Which pawns can take the black pawn?**



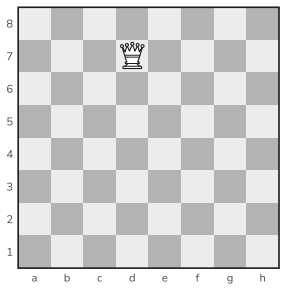
3 **Can this rook reach the top row in one move?**



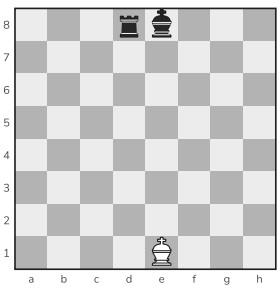
4 **This bishop starts on a dark square. Can it ever reach a light one?**



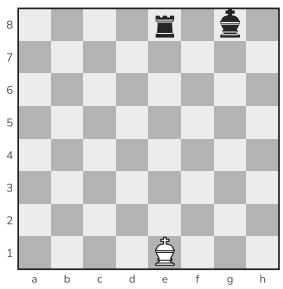
5 **Can this knight get out from behind its pawns?**



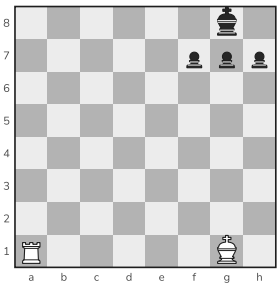
6 **Can the queen reach h3 in one move?**



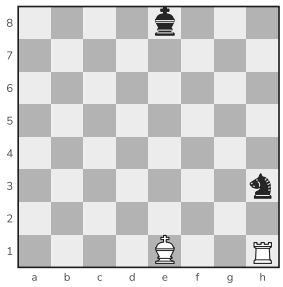
7 **Where can the white king go?**



8 **The black rook gives check. How does the white king get out?**



9 **White to play. One move wins. Which?**



10 **Can White castle?**

ANSWERS

1. d3 or d4. **2.** Both. **3.** No: along the bottom row first, then up. **4.** Never. **5.** Yes: over them to f3 or h3, or it can land on e2. **6.** Yes, diagonally. **7.** e2, f1 or f2. **8.** Step off the e-file: d1, d2, f1 or f2. **9.** Rook to a8, checkmate. **10.** No: the knight on h3 guards g1.

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